

7-0 (A)

Red 12/31/00 wpe

Common Name: Bay-breasted Warbler **Scientific Name:** Dendroica?
Number of Individuals: 1 **Sex:** female **Age:** adult
Locality: Crow Valley Campground, Weld Co, CO
Date(s) Seen: 24 May 2000 **Time:** 1130-1145?
Reporting Observer: Joe Fontaine 3108 Sumac St Fort Collins, CO 80526
Other Observers: Christopher Wood, Joe Himmel
Light Conditions: Slightly overcast sky, looking northwest and slightly up
Optical Equipment: Orion 8x42 binoculars
Distance to Bird: 15-25 meters
Duration of Observation: ~10 minutes
Habitat: Cottonwood-Willow riparian patch

Details: Crow Valley campground on the morning of Wednesday May 24th was very diverse, with 12 species of warblers being reported. Towards the end of the morning I met up with Chris Wood and we decided to make a final check of the SW corner of the campground. Before long, we spotted a female warbler foraging in a large cottonwood tree. Fortunately, the bird spent about ten minutes in this particular tree which allowed several people to see it, including Joe Himmel. This was the first bay-breasted warbler that Joe had seen at Crow Valley.

Description of the Bird: The bird was clearly a member of the Blackburnian/Blackpoll/Bay-breasted complex with a dull gray appearance, two bold wing bars, and very long undertail coverts. The most striking aspect of this particular bird was a bright rufous crown, a dull rufous wash on the breast, and a broken eye ring contrasting strongly against a dark gray cheek.

Similar Species: The presence of a rich crown eliminated Blackburnian, Blackpoll, and Black-and-white. The only other species that shows a strong rufous crown is Palm Warbler which this bird was clearly not. Palm warblers are olive/green overall and frequently bob their tails. The bird in question never bobbed its tail and did not have any olive or green coloration whatsoever. The presence of a fully developed crown and broken eye-ring indicate that the bird was an adult female, the identification of which is straight forward.

Tape Recordings/Photos?

None

Reference: Dunn and Garrett, Warblers

Description from: Notes made shortly after (~3 hours) the sighting

Experience with Species: I have not birded extensively in the eastern forests during spring or fall migration. However, earlier in May of this year I spent over a week birding in eastern Nebraska. During that period I saw 10-15 Blackpoll Warblers. I also had the opportunity to closely observe a female Blackburnian Warbler at Crow Valley Campground on 19 May. Prior to this sighting I had only seen alternate plumaged male Bay-breasted Warblers several years earlier in Maine.

Birders who independently saw the bird: (who I am aware of) None